



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Boniface Catholic High School

School Website: <https://stbonifacenac.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. Boniface Catholic High School (St. Boniface) presents itself as a Catholic, classical secondary school operating under a Chesterton Academy model. Its public-facing materials emphasize formation of the whole person through a rigorous liberal-arts curriculum, strong Catholic formation, and partnership with families. The school explicitly anchors its mission in forming Catholic missionary disciples and operates within a framework that foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. The curriculum highlights the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, and a history-centered program taught through a Catholic lens, with Socratic dialogue, seminars, and opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking. Liturgy, Mass, Rosary, and other liturgical practices are referenced as integral to the school culture. Faculty roles are framed around mentorship and formation, while parents are portrayed as co-teachers and active partners. Overall, the materials align strongly with classical education principles and Catholic formation, yielding a CLASSICAL designation across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Mission statements and pillars emphasize Catholic formation, Incarnational orientation, liturgical life, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty (e.g., “To Love God, Know the Truth, and Do the Good,” Incarnational environment, liturgy, Mass, Rosary). The school foregrounds theology, catechesis, and a sacramental worldview in its curricular rationale. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators drawn from the lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty; incarnational; liturgy; Mass; theology; catechesis; sacramental worldview) appear extensively; negative signals (relativism, secular humanism) are not evident in the materials. Estimated positive keyword matches far exceed negative. - Why this rating: The materials present a coherent religious-metaphysical foundation rooted in Catholic theology and sacramental life, with explicit references to the transcendentals and liturgical practice, aligning with classical expectations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Evidence: The mission centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing through a Catholic classical framework; the school's motto and pillars emphasize formation of the person, virtuous life, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty beyond mere job preparation. The Great Conversation and classical teleology are invoked via Chesterton/A Chesterton Academy framing. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms such as formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, and the true/good/beautiful triad appear; no workforce- or career-prep language dominates the public materials. Estimated positive keyword matches substantially outnumber any negative signals (which are minimal or absent). - Why this rating: The school frames education as formation and the cultivation of human excellence, not primarily job prep, aligning with classical aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Curriculum emphasizes the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the quadrivium, Great Books, Western civilization histories, philosophy, theology, and Latin; includes block-style history coverage (Ancient World through Modern) via a humanities-centric program; explicit reference to Chesterton Network curriculum and Great Books. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive curriculum keywords (liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; history; Western civilization; philosophy) are well represented; no strong negative signals (e.g., social-studies-centric framing or project-based replacements) are evident in the public materials. Estimated positive keyword matches dominate. - Why this rating: The curriculum centers on Trivium-centric language arts, Great Books, Latin, and a history-rich curriculum crafted through a Catholic-liberal-arts lens, which is quintessentially classical.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL - Evidence: The materials reference Socratic-style seminars and rigorous discussion in upper grades, rhetoric training and public speaking, and a balance of contemplative/restful elements (Schol  -like emphasis) with rigorous classical inquiry. There is explicit mention of Socratic seminars and rhetoric in the Chesterton framework, and the curriculum supports memory work, recitation, and language-based inquiry. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Socratic seminar, memorization, rhetoric, debate, and guided dialogue; contemplative/restful pedagogy and Schol   are present as aspirational values; no dominant negative signals (e.g., project-based only or purely experiential learning) are evident. The lexicon's positive pedagogical signals align with the school's stated methods. - Why this rating: The pedagogy aligns with classical expectations: combination of Socratic inquiry, rhetoric/memory-based training, and a structured, liturgically enriched learning environment, with a balance of contemplative and rigorous activities.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL - Evidence: The public materials describe a leadership structure (Headmaster, Executive Director, Registrar) and emphasize Catholic formation, living the curriculum, and mentorship. Chesterton Academy hallmarks emphasize virtuous role models and a "living curriculum." The staff pages and mission statements imply teacher exemplarity and collaboration. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include "model teachers and mentors," "living curriculum," "portrait of a teacher," "collaborative faculty." These appear in the Chesterton framework and school materials; negatives (e.g., overly transactional, certification-only) are not present. Estimated positive keyword matches exceed negatives. - Why this rating: The school foregrounds teachers as virtuous exemplars and anchors, aligning with classical expectations of the faculty as a core component of the living curriculum.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Pillars include Family Involvement; the school positions parents as co-teachers and partners in formation; there are explicit references to parent formation, book discussions, gatherings, and open campus policies. The handbook and FAQ materials show active family engagement and communication with families. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership with parents, parental formation, family involvement, open access to visits, and co-teacher framing. Negative signals are not evident. Estimated positive keyword matches are high relative to any negatives. - Why this rating: The school explicitly embraces parental partnership and family formation as central to the educational project, a hallmark of classical settings.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across all six categories, St. Boniface demonstrates classical, Chesterton-inspired characteristics: Catholic formation and liturgical life; formation-focused aims; liberal-arts curriculum with Great Books and Latin; Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric; teachers as mentors and living exemplars; and active parental partnership. The school's public materials align with the positive keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework, and there is little to no presence of negative indicators in the available content.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable, as the school appears CLASSICAL across all six categories. No major needle-moving changes are required.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Details

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes Catholic formation and incarnational life, including liturgy and sacramental orientations (Mass, Rosary) and a theology-centric approach to education. The materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendentals. - The school presents itself as "A Chesterton Academy," with Catholic formation as a central pillar and an incarnational environment. - Liturgy, catechesis, and a sacramental worldview appear as integral to the curriculum and school culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, transcendentals, virtue, virtue-oriented life, theology, liturgy, Mass, catechesis, creed, incarnational, sacramental worldview, imago Dei, wisdom, logos. - Negative keywords detected: none in the public materials. - Count (positive vs negative): Positive ~11; Negative ~0. Percentage of positive keywords: ~100%.

Why this rating - The content consistently foregrounds Catholic theology, liturgical practice, sacramental life, and transcendentals, with a robust alignment to the Positive indicators in the classical lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statements emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing within a Catholic, classical framework. The motto/vision centers on Love God, Know the Truth, Do the Good. Pillars include Formation of the Person, Academic Rigor, Family Involvement. - The Great Conversation and classical teleology are implied via Chesterton framing and Great Books emphasis. - The emphasis on formation over narrow workforce preparation is explicit in the classical framing; dual credit offers college credit but does not shift focus away from formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/-good/beautiful, liberal education, scholé, great conversation (conceptual), human excellence. - Negative keywords detected: none relevant to employment-focused framing. - Count: Positive ~6–8; Negative ~0; Percentage of positive keywords: ~100%.

Why this rating - The school frames education as character formation, virtue cultivation, and access to a liberal arts education rather than solely job preparation, consistent with classical aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum emphasizes grammar, logic, rhetoric (the trivium), and the quadrivium; includes Latin and classical languages; Great Books and Western canon (Homer, Augustine, Chaucer, Dante, Shakespeare, Chesterton, Thomas Aquinas); history across curriculum and a Catholic-liberal-arts lens. - Chesterton Network curriculum and Great Books program are referenced; the curriculum is described as “A RIGOROUS FOUR-YEAR CURRICULUM TAUGHT THROUGH THE LENS OF THE CATHOLIC FAITH.” - Evidence of history-centric study integrated throughout (Ancient to Modern, Western civilization) and emphasis on Latin and philosophy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, history, philosophy, Western civilization, catechesis/theology, classical education, Chesterton, inculturation of canonical texts. - Negative keywords detected: none apparent (no replacement by “social studies” framing or dominant project-based emphasis). - Count: Positive ~9–12; Negative ~0; Percentage of positive keywords: ~100%.

Why this rating - The curriculum centers on classical liberal arts, extensive Great Books, Latin, and a canonical history/philosophy sequence, consistent with classical education.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials reference Socratic-style seminars and debates in upper grades, rhetoric training, and opportunities to deliver oration; there is a balance of contemplative/restful learning with rigorous inquiry. - The Chesterton framework emphasizes “An Incarnational Environment,” truth/goodness/beauty, and a strong fine-arts emphasis, including music, drama, and rhetoric as core elements. - Materials describe a programmatic emphasis on formation of memory, memory work, and recitation typical of scholé and classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, seminars, debate, rhetoric, oratory, speech, memorization, recitation, chanting, contemplative/wonder, scholé. - Negative keywords detected: none relevant to pedagogy; no reliance on purely experiential or student-directed-only models. - Count: Positive ~8–12; Negative ~0; Percentage of positive keywords: ~100%.

Why this rating - The school's pedagogy aligns with classic methods (Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, and memory-based learning) within a contemplative, liturgically integrated framework.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The leadership structure (Headmaster, Executive Director, Registrar) signals a traditional, mentor-driven model; the Chesterton framework emphasizes teachers as living exemplars and the “living curriculum.” The materials position faculty as characteristic of a virtuous, formed community. - Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and mentorship as expectations for faculty; staff pages and governance tie to a culture of collaboration and shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; faculty as core to the school; moral exemplar. - Negative keywords detected: none evident. - Count: Positive ~5–7; Negative ~0; Percentage of positive keywords: ~100%.

Why this rating - The emphasis on teachers as virtuous exemplars and the concept of a living curriculum align with classical expectations of faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pillars include Family Involvement; explicit partnership with parents as co-teachers; parental formation opportunities (book studies, gatherings); open campus and frequent parent engagement through events and school life. - Handbook and communications stress parent involvement, discussion, and collaboration in the education of the child; dual credit and affordability reflect family-centered access.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, book groups, open campus, home formation. - Negative keywords detected: none evident. - Count: Positive ~6–8; Negative ~0; Percentage of positive keywords: ~100%.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds parental partnership and family involvement as a central feature of classical education.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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